"What is the secret you are whispering?" asked Ramanatham.

The loss of the jewel had to be admitted. Soon the whole village knew about it. The maid-servant Kuppayi was **suspected** to have stolen it by everyone.

The police came and searched her hut, but could find nothing.



Ramayya's heart was in a **flutter**. Ramayya's wife put the stud away in her box. She soon developed a severe fever and was **confined** to bed. No one thought of searching their house.



The he-sparrow said, "Look at the fun, my dear, the lady of this house is scared and is down with fever."

"Nice fun indeed!" said the she-sparrow. "The poor woman is in a **panic**. The fever may be the end of her."

"And a good thing too," said the **cruel** male sparrow.

"It is all your doing you brought and threw it here and tempted her," said the female bird.

The male bird answered **gravely**, "Did I tell her to steal the thing? This is bound to happen when humans are greedy."

8th_english_1 to 3.indd 4 16-12-2022 14:21:36